ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 2: **The Price Puzzle (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** monopolist	Monopoly
2	**(d)** downward	Inverse relation
3	**(d)** income rises	Income effect
4	**(c)** upward	Direct relation
5	**(b)** shortage	Qd > Qs
6	**(b)** free rider	Free-rider
7	**(b)** rise	Law of supply
8	**(d)** banking	Bank regulator
9	**(a)** revenue	Definition
10	**(a)** telecom	Telecom regulator

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Quantity supplied rises with price (1); Direct relation (1).	1+1
12	Total demand of all buyers (1); Sum of individual demands (1).	1+1
13	Roads (1); Street lights (1).	1+1
14	Supply exceeds demand at a price (1); It tends to pull price down (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Storing goods in excess (1); Creates artificial shortage (1); Prices rise (1).	1+1+1
16	Price distortions (1); Compliance burden (1); Less innovation (1).	1+1+1
17	Add individual supplies (1); 1+3+2 = 6 kg (1); That is market supply at Rs 50 (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Government fixes maximum price (1); Rs 100 for 200 ml (1); Protects consumers (1).	1+1+1
18	Income (1); Taste (1); Price of related goods (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Demand is by buyers, supply by sellers (1); Demand falls with price, supply rises (1); Demand curve slopes down, supply curve up (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Price of related goods (1); Income (1); Taste (1); Population (1); Seasonality and expectations (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Private firms see no profit (1); Free-rider problem (1); All citizens need them (1); Roads, parks, street lights (1); Funded by taxes (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Qd equals Qs (1); Rs 100 and 12 kg in the table (1); Below it, shortage (1); Above it, surplus (1); Price adjusts to equilibrium (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: One seller with no close substitute (1); Can charge high prices (1); May supply poor quality (1); May restrict supply (1); Government keeps price and quantity in check (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Do not confuse a **movement along** a demand or supply curve (caused by a change in the good's own price) with a **shift** of the curve (caused by income, tastes, related goods, technology, etc.).
- Excess demand = shortage (price below equilibrium); excess supply = surplus (price above equilibrium). Students often reverse these.
- Substitutes (tea and coffee) move in the same direction of demand when the price of the other changes; complements (smartphone and earphones) go together. Do not interchange them.
- A price ceiling is a **maximum** price and a price floor (e.g. minimum wage) is a **minimum** price; a floor below equilibrium or a ceiling above equilibrium has no effect.
- Market demand is the **sum** of all buyers' demands at a price (e.g. 1 + 2 + 3 = 6 kg); write the values for the same price, not different prices.

- In the real world equilibrium is not stable because demand and supply keep changing (pandemics, weather); the regulators are RBI (banking), SEBI (securities), TRAI (telecom) and CCPA (consumers).

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 2: **The Price Puzzle (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** public goods	Non-excludable
2	**(d)** supply falls	Shortage
3	**(b)** willing and able to buy	Definition
4	**(b)** storing goods beyond need to sell later at a higher price	Illegal practice in shortages
5	**(a)** price ceiling	Upper limit
6	**(d)** surplus	Qs > Qd
7	**(c)** 1955	Year
8	**(a)** price floor	Lower limit
9	**(b)** demand is very high	High demand
10	**(b)** Tea and coffee	Replace each other

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Illegal trade in banned or regulated goods (1); Often done in shortages (1).	1+1
12	Total supply of all sellers (1); Sum of individual supplies (1).	1+1
13	Goods used together (1); Car and petrol (1).	1+1
14	Price where demand equals supply (1); Neither shortage nor surplus (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Add individual demands (1); 2+4+6 = 12 kg (1); This is market demand at Rs 100 (1).	1+1+1
16	Technology (1); Number of sellers (1); Price of related goods (1).	1+1+1
17	RBI - banking (1); SEBI - securities (1); TRAI - telecom (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Demand is very high (1); Rooms are fixed in number (1); Hotels charge higher tariffs (1).	1+1+1
18	Money from sales before expenses (1); They change tariff to maximise it (1); They watch bookings and rivals (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Supply rises (1); Supply exceeds demand (1); Price falls (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Price change moves along the curve (1); Income, taste shift the curve (1); Related goods matter (1); Population and season matter (1); Expectations matter (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Technology lowers cost, e.g. drip irrigation (1); Sensors raise yield (1); Expected demand boom raises output (1); Expected fall lowers it (1); Stockholding of potatoes (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Price and quantity supplied move together (1); Higher price brings more profit (1); Producers expand output (1); New firms enter (1); Mangoes supplied more mid-season (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Individual supply: one seller's quantity at each price (1); At Rs 50 the sellers supply 1, 3 and 2 kg (1); Market supply is the sum, 6 kg (1); At Rs 150: 3 + 7 + 8 = 18 kg (1); Upward-sloping curves (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 2: **The Price Puzzle (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Income of consumers	Income
2	**(d)** National defence	Public good
3	**(a)** the securities market	Share market
4	**(c)** supply increases	More supply
5	**(c)** Car and petrol	Used together
6	**(d)** market demand	Add up
7	**(c)** woollens	Seasonality
8	**(a)** rises	Law of demand
9	**(a)** demand equals supply	Market clears
10	**(d)** increases	More sellers

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Goods that replace each other (1); Tea and coffee (1).	1+1
12	Quantity sellers are willing and able to offer (1); At a particular price (1).	1+1
13	Demand exceeds supply at a price (1); It tends to push price up (1).	1+1
14	Banking in India (1); Ensures stability (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Many people think others will pay (1); Too little money is collected (1); Government must provide the good (1).	1+1+1
16	Minimum price set by law (1); Minimum wage (1); Protects producers or workers (1).	1+1+1
17	Demand surged (1); Prices rose (1); Later fell as supply adjusted (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Price and quantity demanded move oppositely (1); Price on y-axis (1); Curve slopes downward (1).	1+1+1
18	One seller controls supply (1); Higher prices (1); Poorer quality (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Available to all (1); Roads (1); Parks and street lights (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Prevents unfair practices (1); Price ceilings and floors (1); Controls monopoly (1); Stops hoarding (1); Provides public goods (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Demand surged in 2020 (1); Supply could not catch up quickly (1); Prices rose (1); Suppliers adjusted and prices fell (1); After the pandemic, demand dropped (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Quantity demanded falls when price rises (1); Rises when price falls (1); Buyers buy less when costly (1); Marginal utility diminishes (1); Mangoes bought more as price falls (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Price distortions reduce producer incentive (1); Compliance burden hurts small firms (1); Innovation and entrepreneurship fall (1); Example: wheat ceiling (1); Ease of doing business suffers (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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